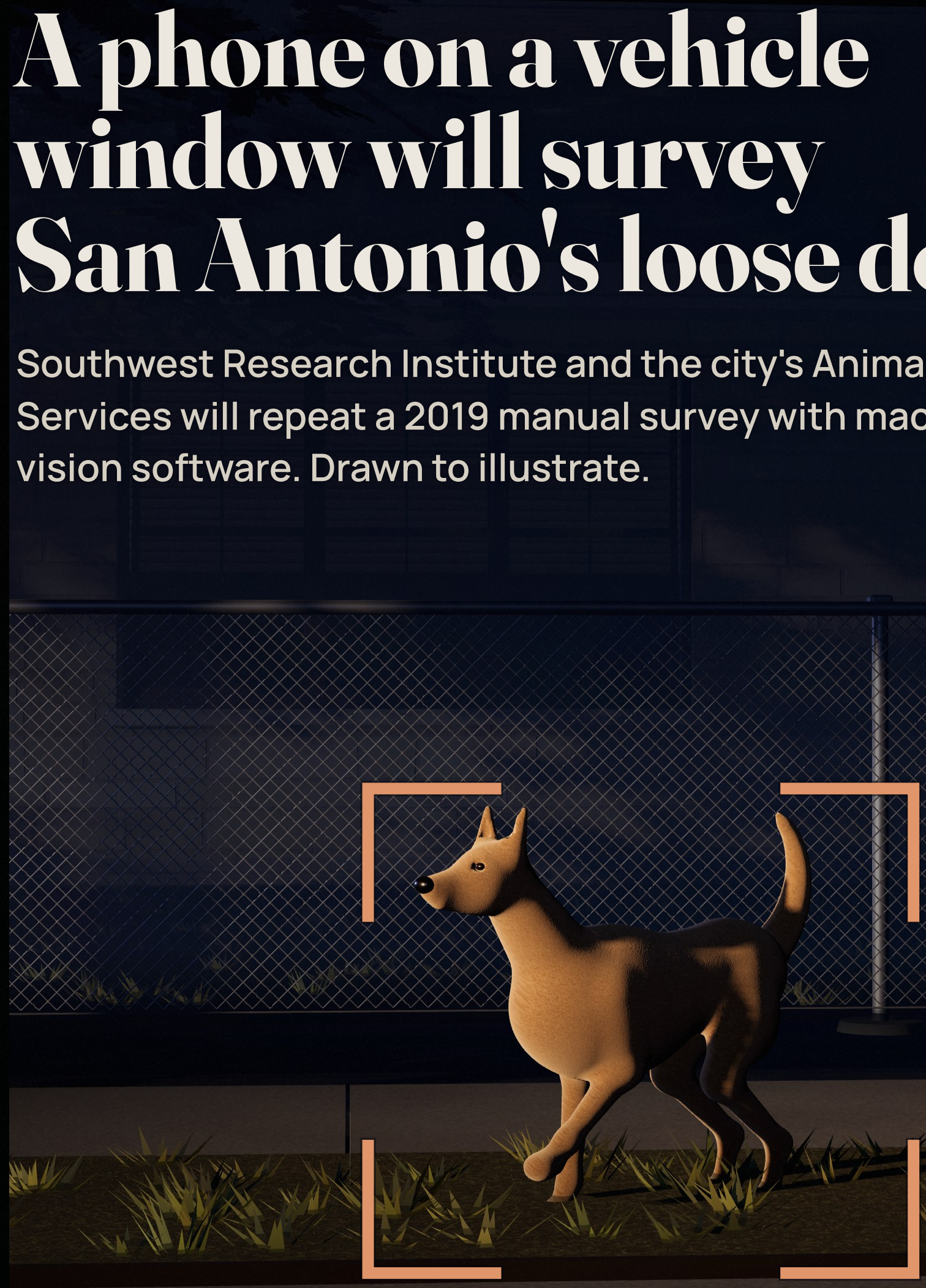
A phone on a vehicle window will survey San Antonio's loose dogs

Southwest Research Institute and the city's Animal Care Services will repeat a 2019 manual survey with machine vision software. Drawn to illustrate.



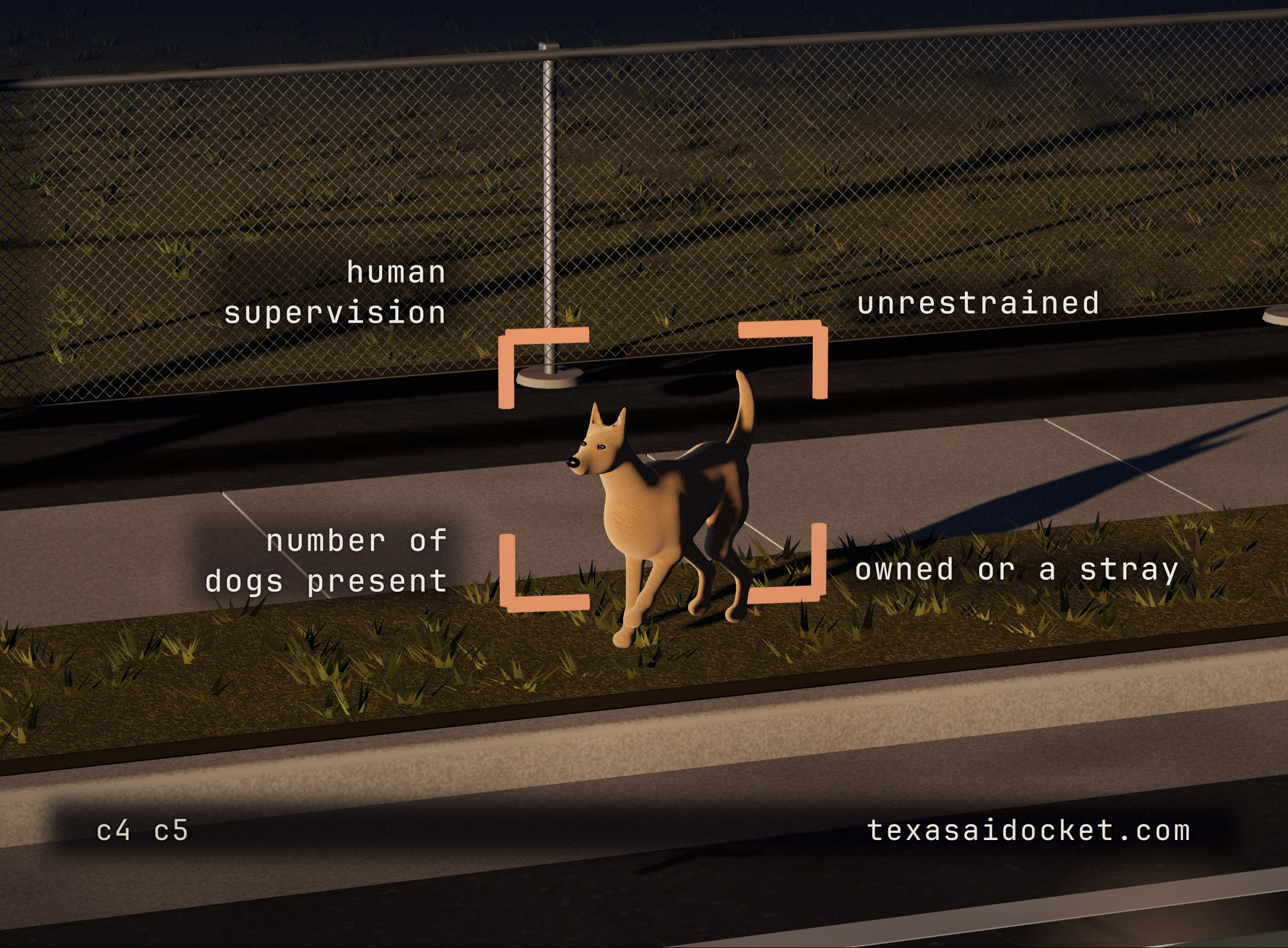
The camera is a phone

The release describes "a cellular phone mounted to a vehicle window with object detection and data analysis software".



Four checks on each clip

Video clips will go to automated and human review. Each detected dog will be checked.



Two labels for a loose dog

The release says strays "appear to be malnourished and skittish". Dogs that seem healthier and more approachable "are likely owned by local families and are classified as roaming." Drawn to illustrate.



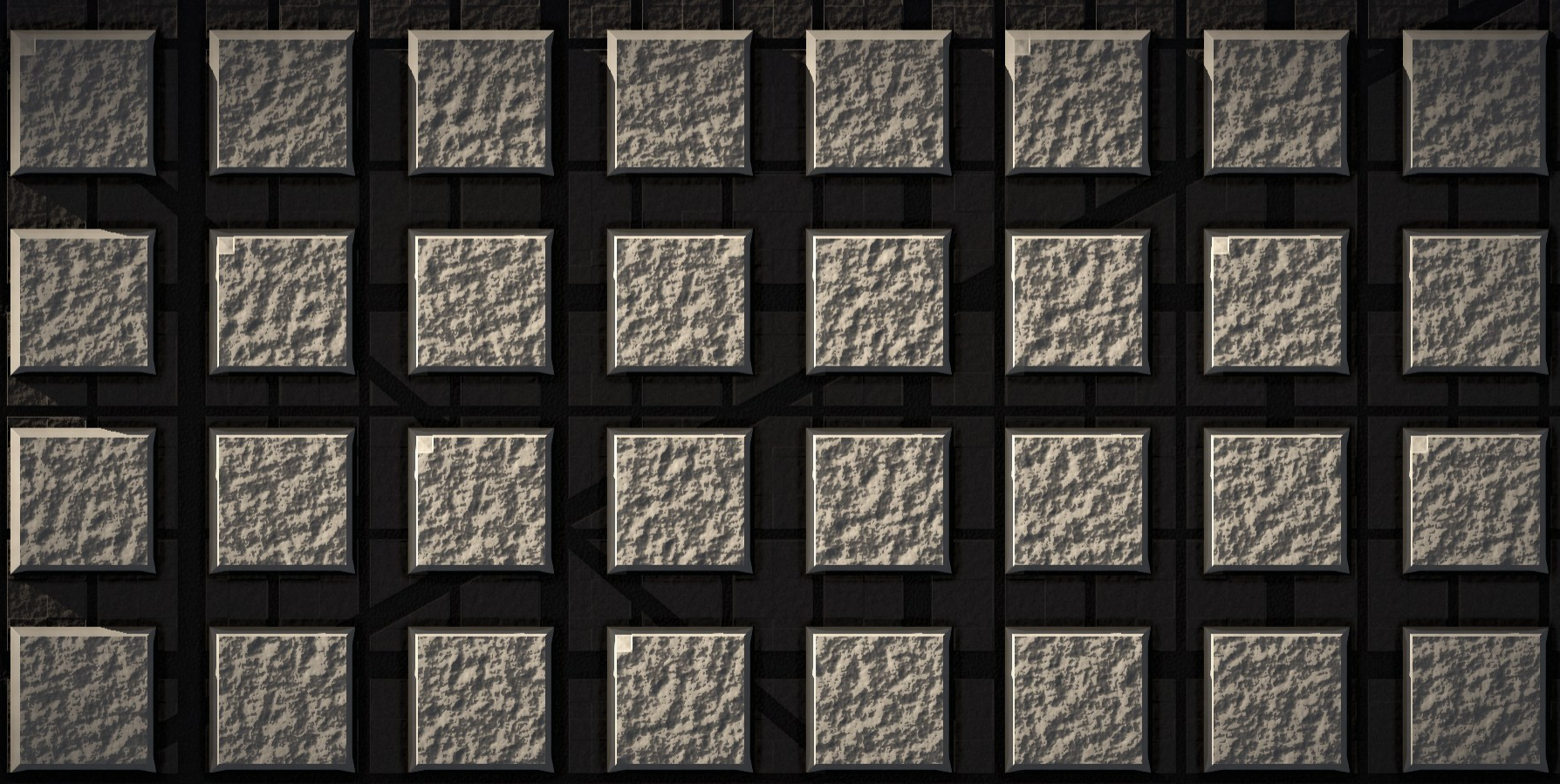
A person reviews the clips too

The release says automated and human review of the video clips "will verify that the detected animals were unrestrained."



32 study areas, not the whole city

The city says the project is not intended to count every unrestrained dog in San Antonio. SwRI says the study takes a sampling approach rather than surveying the whole city.



The same 32 places as 2019

The 2019 survey was done by hand. The automated survey will repeat it in the same study areas. The 2019 findings are not shown here.



c9 c10 c17 c22

October to December on the street, then a report

Field research is expected to run through December. SwRI will then forward Animal Care Services a final report on the study's findings and data.

final report



The ACS director calls it another tool

ACS Director Jon Gary says the study gives the city "another tool to better understand where we are seeing unrestrained dogs". SwRI will forward the final report to the department.

